

সূচী পত্র

- **1. Indian Geography & Environment**
 - **Divisions:** Regional Parts and Central Territories.
 - **Rivers:** Major river systems and networks.
 - **Ecological Markers:** Biodiversity Hotspots (BH), World Natural Heritage Sites (WNHS), Biosphere Reserves (BR).
- **2. Indian Constitution**
 - **Parts (P):** The Preamble and individual chapters.
 - **Articles (PrA / A):** Specific provisions, rights, and laws.
 - **Schedules (S):** Categorized lists supporting the Articles.
- **3. Ancient to Medieval Indian History**
 - **Early Civilizations:** Indus Valley Civilization (IVC), Aryan.
 - **Magadha Dynasties:** Haryanka, Shishunaga, Nanda, Maurya, Shunga, Kanva.
 - **Foreign Invasions & Classical Empires:** Indo-Greeks, Shaka, Kushana, Gupta, Huna.
 - **Delhi Sultanate (Turkic Rule):**
 - Ghulam / Slave Dynasty (Qutb-ud-din Aibak, Iltutmish, Razia Sultana, Ghiyas-ud-din Balban)
 - Khalji Dynasty
 - Tughlaq Dynasty
 - Sayyid Dynasty
 - Lodi Dynasty
 - **Later Empires & Arrivals:** Mongol, Mughal, Iranian, Afghan, European.
 - **Historical Markers:** Prashasti Pillars.
- **4. Assam Geography, Environment & Conservation**
 - **Physiographic Divisions:** Brahmaputra Valley, Barak Valley, Central Plateau/Hills.
 - **River Systems:** North Bank (NB) Tributaries, South Bank (SB) Tributaries, Barak River.
 - **Ecology & General Conservation:** BH, WNHS, BR, National Parks (NP), Wildlife Sanctuaries (WS), Bird Sanctuaries (BS), and Wetlands (Beels).
 - **Specialized Conservation Reserves:**
 - **Tiger Reserves (TR):** Manas, Nameri, Kaziranga, Orang.
 - **Elephant Reserves (ER):** Kaziranga-Karbi Anglong, Dhansiri-Lungding, Chirang-Ripu, Sonitpur, Dihing Patkai.
- **5. Assam Infrastructure: Transport Networks**
 - **Roadways:** Major National Highways (NH-27, NH-15, NH-127, NH-137, NH-306, NH-715).
 - **Railways:** North-East Frontier Railway (NFR) zone, broad gauge network, and major regional junctions.
- **6. Literary Sources of Assam History**
 - **Vedic Literature:** Aitareya, Satapatha, and Gopatha Brahmanas.
 - **The Great Epics:** Ramayana and Mahabharata.
 - **Puranas & Tantric Texts:**
 - The 7 Puranas and their regional references.
 - **Boundaries of Kamarupa (Yogini Tantra):** Kanjagiri (North), Brahmaputra-Laksha confluence (South), Karatoya (West), Dikhu (East).
 - **Division of Pithas:**
 - **Yogini Tantra:** Ratnapitha, Bhadrapiitha, Saumarapiitha, Kamapitha.
 - **Kalika Purana:** Ratnapitha, Swarnapiitha, Saumarapiitha, Kamapitha.
- **7. Assam History & State Polity**
 - **Ancient Kamarupa:** Mythological Period, Varman, Mlechchha, Pala Dynasties.
 - **Medieval Assam:** Ahom, Koch, Chutiya, Kachari, Baro-Bhuyans.
 - **Modern Era & Colonial Assam:** Annexation (Treaty of Yandabo), Early Uprisings, Agrarian Revolts, Administrative Milestones (Indigo Commission, Chief Commissioner's Province), Freedom Movement.
 - **Polity:** State Legislature, Sixth Schedule Areas (BTR, KAAC, NCHAC).
- **8. Northeast India (The Seven Sisters)**
 - **States Covered:** Arunachal Pradesh, Assam, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, Tripura.
 - **Key Profiles per State:**
 - Capitals
 - State Symbols (Animal, Bird, Flower)
 - Special Conserved Animals
 - Important National Parks
 - Highest Peaks
 - Major Hill Ranges
- **9. Prehistory of Northeast India (Map-Based Sites)**
 - **Paleolithic Period:**
 - Middle Paleolithic: Daphabum (Lohit Valley).
 - Late Paleolithic: Rongram Valley (Garo Hills), Khangkhui (Ukhru).
 - **Neolithic Period & Significant Finds:**
 - Neolithic Sites: Sarutaru (Kamrup), Selbagiri (Garo Hills), Daojali Hading (Dima-Hasao).
 - Artifact Locations: Biswanath (Six-grooved Hammer).

Chapter 1: Indian Geography & Environment

1. Physiographic Divisions of India

India's distinct geographical features are traditionally categorized into six major physiographic divisions.

- **The Northern Mountains (The Himalayas):**
 - **Structure:** A geologically young and structurally fold mountain system stretching along the northern borders.
 - **Sub-divisions:**
 - **Himadri (Greater Himalayas):** The innermost, continuous range containing the highest peaks (e.g., Mt. Everest, Kanchenjunga).
 - **Himachal (Lesser Himalayas):** Known for hill stations and rugged terrain (e.g., Pir Panjal, Dhauladhar).
 - **Shivaliks (Outer Himalayas):** The outermost range composed of unconsolidated sediments.
- **The Northern Plains (Indo-Gangetic Plain):**
 - **Formation:** Formed by the interplay of three major river systems: the Indus, the Ganga, and the Brahmaputra, along with their tributaries.
 - **Soil Type:** Highly fertile alluvial soil, making it the most agriculturally productive and densely populated region.
- **The Peninsular Plateau (Including Central Territories):**
 - **Central Highlands:** Lies to the north of the Narmada river, bounded by the Vindhya range and Aravalis. Characterized by the Malwa plateau.
 - **Deccan Plateau:** A triangular landmass situated to the south of the Narmada river, flanked by the Eastern and Western Ghats. It is rich in mineral resources and features black soil (Deccan Trap) ideal for cotton cultivation.
- **The Indian Desert (Thar Desert):**
 - **Location:** Lies towards the western margins of the Aravali Hills in Rajasthan.
 - **Climate:** Arid climate with low vegetation cover and very low annual rainfall (below 150 mm).
- **The Coastal Plains:**
 - **Western Coastal Plains:** A narrow strip between the Western Ghats and the Arabian Sea (divided into Konkan, Kannad, and Malabar coasts).
 - **Eastern Coastal Plains:** Broader plains between the Eastern Ghats and the Bay of Bengal (divided into Northern Circars and the Coromandel Coast), known for large river deltas.
- **The Islands:**
 - **Andaman and Nicobar (Bay of Bengal):** Volcanic origin, larger in size, and rich in biodiversity.
 - **Lakshadweep (Arabian Sea):** Coral origin (atolls), covering a smaller geographical area.

2. Major River Systems

The Indian drainage system is broadly divided into two major categories based on their origin and characteristics.

- **Himalayan River Systems (Perennial Rivers):**
 - **The Indus System:** Originates in Tibet near Lake Mansarovar. Major tributaries include the Jhelum, Chenab, Ravi, Beas, and Sutlej.
 - **The Ganga System:** Originates as the Bhagirathi from the Gangotri glacier. Major tributaries include the Yamuna, Ghaghara, Gandak, Kosi, and Son.
 - **The Brahmaputra System:** Originates in Tibet (known as Tsangpo). Enters India through Arunachal Pradesh and forms a massive network in Assam.
- **Peninsular River Systems (Seasonal/Rain-fed Rivers):**
 - **West-Flowing Rivers:**
 - **Narmada & Tapi:** These rivers flow through rift valleys into the Arabian Sea and form estuaries instead of deltas.
 - **East-Flowing Rivers:**
 - **Mahanadi, Godavari, Krishna, and Cauvery:** These rivers flow into the Bay of Bengal and form large, fertile deltas at their mouths. The Godavari is the largest peninsular river (often called Dakshin Ganga).

3. Ecological Markers & Conservation

India is a mega-diverse country with specific frameworks for protecting its natural environment.

- **BH (Biodiversity Hotspots):**
 - **Definition:** Biogeographic regions that are both significant reservoirs of biodiversity and threatened by human destruction. India hosts 4 out of the 36 globally recognized hotspots.
 - **The 4 Indian Hotspots:**
 1. **The Himalayas:** Includes the entire Indian Himalayan region (and parts of Pakistan, Tibet, Nepal, Bhutan, China, and Myanmar).
 2. **Indo-Burma:** Includes the entire North-Eastern India (except Assam and Andaman), along with Myanmar, Thailand, Vietnam, Laos, and Cambodia.
 3. **Western Ghats and Sri Lanka:** Runs parallel to the western coast of the Indian peninsula.
 4. **Sundaland:** Includes the Nicobar group of Islands (and extends into Southeast Asia).
- **WNHS (World Natural Heritage Sites):**
 - **Definition:** Natural features or areas designated by UNESCO for having outstanding universal value based on science, conservation, or natural beauty.
 - **Key Indian Examples:** Kaziranga National Park, Manas Wildlife Sanctuary, Keoladeo National Park, Sundarbans National Park, Nanda Devi and Valley of Flowers National Parks, Western Ghats, and Great Himalayan National Park Conservation Area.
- **BHere is the updated and fully expanded section for BR (Biosphere Reserves) to replace the previous entry in your Chapter 1 notes. All 18 Biosphere Reserves of India are now included, along with their respective states, which will be highly useful for your students' geographical mapping.**

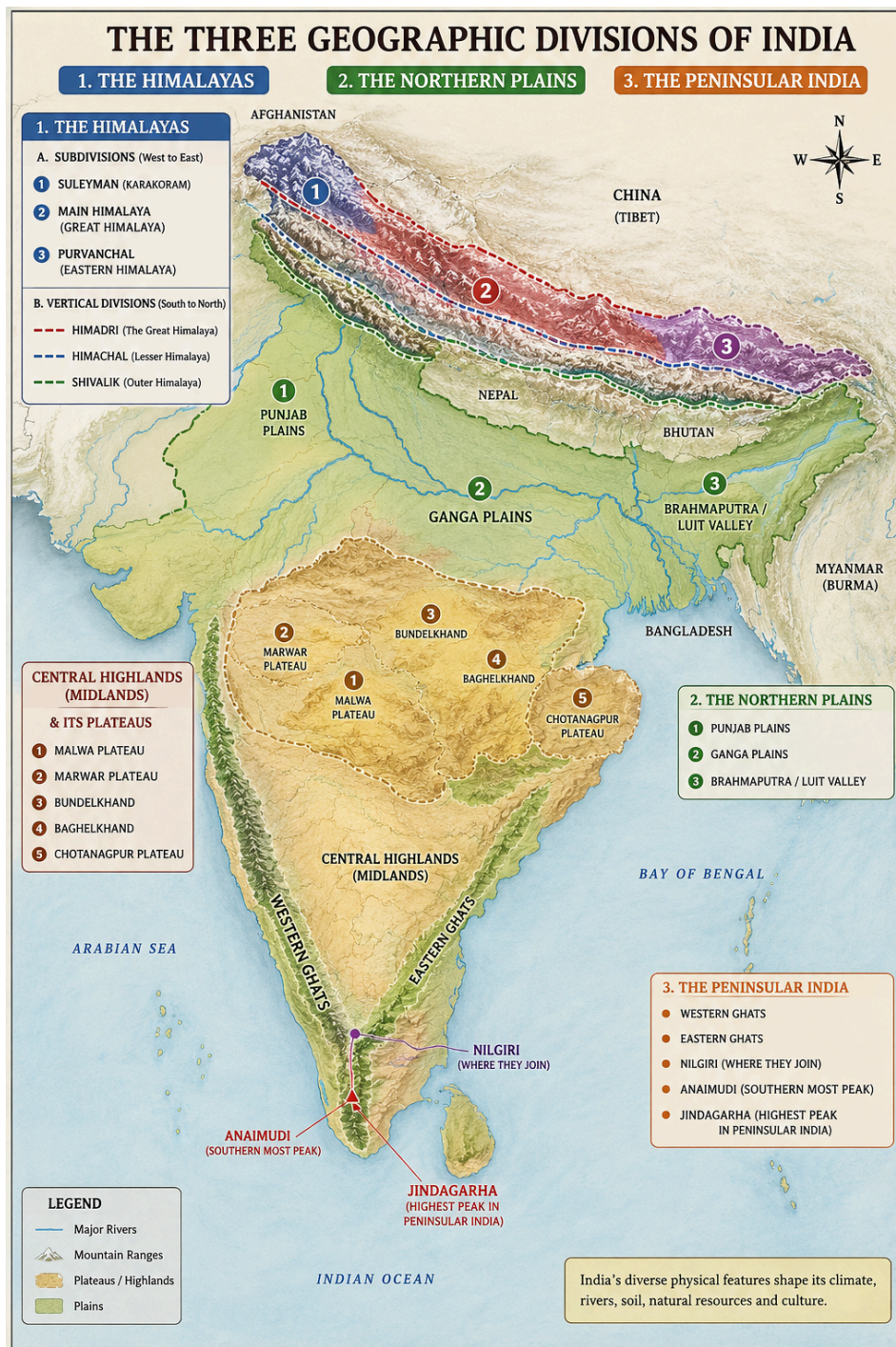
3. Ecological Markers & Conservation (Updated Section)

- **BR (Biosphere Reserves):**
 - **Definition:** Large, multi-purpose protected areas created to conserve the genetic diversity of species within their natural ecosystems. They allow for a balanced integration of conservation, sustainable local human development, and scientific research.
 - **Scale:** India has a total of 18 officially notified Biosphere Reserves.

- **Global Recognition:** Out of these 18, exactly 12 are internationally recognized under the UNESCO Man and the Biosphere (MAB) Programme.

- **The 18 Biosphere Reserves of India:**

- Nilgiri (Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Karnataka) — First established; [UNESCO MAB]
- Nanda Devi (Uttarakhand) — [UNESCO MAB]
- Nokrek (Meghalaya) — [UNESCO MAB]
- Gulf of Mannar (Tamil Nadu) — [UNESCO MAB]
- Sunderbans (West Bengal) — [UNESCO MAB]
- Manas (Assam)
- Great Nicobar (Andaman & Nicobar Islands) — [UNESCO MAB]
- Similipal (Odisha) — [UNESCO MAB]
- Dibru-Saikhowa (Assam) — Smallest by geographical area
- Dehang-Dibang (Arunachal Pradesh)
- Pachmarhi (Madhya Pradesh) — [UNESCO MAB]
- Khangchendzonga (Sikkim) — [UNESCO MAB]
- Agasthyamalai (Kerala, Tamil Nadu) — [UNESCO MAB]
- Achanakmar-Amarkantak (Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh) — [UNESCO MAB]
- Kachchh (Gujarat) — Largest by geographical area
- Cold Desert (Himachal Pradesh)
- Seshachalam Hills (Andhra Pradesh)
- Panna (Madhya Pradesh) — [UNESCO MAB]



Chapter 2: Indian Constitution

1. The Preamble (P)

The Preamble serves as the introduction or preface to the Constitution, outlining the fundamental values, philosophy, and objectives of the document.

- **Nature of the State:** It declares India to be a Sovereign, Socialist, Secular, Democratic, and Republic polity. (Note: "Socialist" and "Secular" were added by the 42nd Amendment Act in 1976).
- **Objectives:**
 - **Justice:** Social, economic, and political.
 - **Liberty:** Of thought, expression, belief, faith, and worship.
 - **Equality:** Of status and opportunity.
 - **Fraternity:** Assuring the dignity of the individual and the unity and integrity of the Nation.

2. Parts of the Constitution (P)

The Constitution is systematically divided into "Parts," which act like chapters in a book, grouping related Articles together. While originally containing 22 Parts, amendments have brought the total to 25.

Crucial Parts for Examination:

- **Part I: The Union and its Territory.**
- **Part II: Citizenship.**
- **Part III (Fundamental Rights):** Often called the Magna Carta of India. Guarantees basic human rights to citizens.
- **Part IV (Directive Principles of State Policy - DPSP):** Guidelines for the government to create social and economic conditions under which citizens can lead a good life.
- **Part IVA (Fundamental Duties):** Moral obligations of all citizens to help promote a spirit of patriotism and uphold the unity of India.
- **Part V: The Union (Executive, Parliament, Supreme Court).**
- **Part VI: The States (Executive, State Legislature, High Courts).**
- **Part IX: The Panchayats (Rural local self-government).**
- **Part IXA: The Municipalities (Urban local self-government).**
- **Part XI: Relations between the Union and the States (Center-State relations).**
- **Part XV: Elections (Includes the Election Commission).**
- **Part XVIII: Emergency Provisions.**
- **Part XX: Amendment of the Constitution.**

3. Articles (PrA / A)

Articles are the individual, numbered rules and provisions that dictate the law of the land. The original Constitution had 395 Articles.

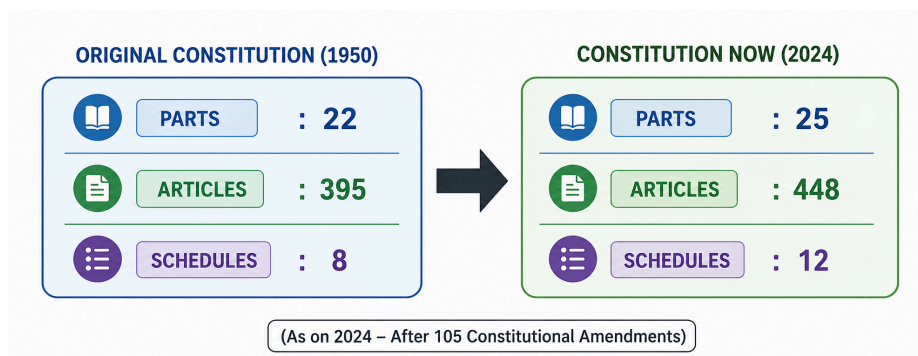
Key Landmark Articles:

- **Article 14: Equality before the law and equal protection of the laws.**
- **Article 19: Protection of six fundamental freedoms (speech, assembly, association, movement, residence, and profession).**
- **Article 21: Protection of life and personal liberty.**
- **Article 32: Right to Constitutional Remedies (allowing citizens to move the Supreme Court for the enforcement of Fundamental Rights).**
- **Article 44: Uniform Civil Code (a Directive Principle).**
- **Article 51A: Details the 11 Fundamental Duties.**
- **Article 352: National Emergency.**
- **Article 356: State Emergency (President's Rule).**
- **Article 360: Financial Emergency.**
- **Article 368: Power of Parliament to amend the Constitution.**

4. Schedules (S) (TEARS OF OLD PM)

Schedules are lists or tables categorized at the end of the Constitution that provide additional details, bureaucratic processes, and specific administrative policies not fully outlined in the Articles. (Originally 8, presently 12).

- **1st Schedule:** Lists the names of the States and Union Territories with their territorial jurisdiction. (**TERRITORY**)
- **2nd Schedule:** Provisions relating to the salaries, allowances, and privileges of the President, Governors, Chief Justices, Judges, and the CAG. (**EMOLUMENTS**)
- **3rd Schedule:** Forms of Oaths and Affirmations for Union Ministers, MPs, Judges, and State Ministers. (**AFFIRMATIONS**)
- **4th Schedule:** Allocation of seats in the Rajya Sabha (Council of States) to the States and Union Territories. (**RAJYA SABHA**)
- **5th Schedule:** Provisions regarding the administration and control of Scheduled Areas and Scheduled Tribes. (**SCHEDULED AREA**)
- **6th Schedule:** Provisions for the administration of Tribal Areas in the states of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, and Mizoram (Directly connects to your Assam Polity module: BTR, KAAC, NCHAC). (**OTHER SCHEDULED AREA**)
- **7th Schedule:** Division of powers between the Union and the States via three lists: (**FEDERAL PROVISIONS**)
 - List I (Union List)
 - List II (State List)
 - List III (Concurrent List)
- **8th Schedule:** Lists the 22 official languages recognized by the Constitution (including Assamese and Bodo). (**Official LANGUAGE**)
- **9th Schedule:** Acts and Regulations originally added to protect land reform laws from judicial review. (**LAND REFORM**)
- **10th Schedule:** Anti-Defection Law (provisions regarding disqualification on grounds of defection). (**DEFECTION**)
- **11th Schedule:** Specifies the powers, authority, and responsibilities of Panchayats (contains 29 matters). (**PANCHAYAT**)
- **12th Schedule:** Specifies the powers, authority, and responsibilities of Municipalities (contains 18 matters). (**MUNICIPALITY**)



Chapter 3: Ancient to Medieval Indian History

1. Early Civilizations

- **IVC (Indus Valley Civilization):**
 - A Bronze Age civilization known for its advanced urban planning, baked brick houses, elaborate drainage systems, and water supply systems.
 - Major sites include Harappa, Mohenjo-Daro, Lothal, and Dholavira.
- **Aryan / Vedic Age:**
 - The period following the decline of the IVC, marked by the migration of Indo-Aryan speakers and the composition of the Vedas.
 - Transitioned from a semi-nomadic, pastoral life (Early Vedic) to settled agriculture and the formation of territorial states or Mahajanapadas (Later Vedic).

2. Magadha Dynasties (The First Empires) (HA ShI NA MA SHU KA)

Magadha emerged as the most powerful Mahajanapada, leading to a succession of major dynasties.

- **Haryank (Haryanka Dynasty):** Founded by Bimbisara, who expanded the empire through matrimonial alliances and conquests. Succeeded by his son Ajatashatru.
- **Shisunag (Shishunaga Dynasty):** Temporarily shifted the capital to Vaishali and finally destroyed the power of the rival Avanti state.
- **Nand (Nanda Dynasty):** Founded by Mahapadma Nanda. It was a massive, wealthy, and militarily powerful empire in the north during the time of Alexander the Great's invasion.
- **Maurya (Mauryan Empire):**
 - Founded by Chandragupta Maurya (with the help of Chanakya) by overthrowing the Nandas.
 - It reached its zenith under Ashoka the Great, who embraced Buddhism after the Kalinga War and propagated Dhamma.
- **Shunga (Shunga Dynasty):** Established by Pushyamitra Shunga after assassinating the last Mauryan king, marking a revival of Brahminical traditions.
- **Kanva (Kanva Dynasty):** A minor Brahmin dynasty founded by Vasudeva Kanva that briefly ruled Magadha after the fall of the Shungas.

3. Foreign Invasions & Classical Empires

Post-Mauryan period saw an influx of Central Asian tribes, followed by the rise of a powerful indigenous empire.

- **Indogreek (Indo-Greeks):** Hellenistic kings who ruled parts of northwest India. Famous for issuing the first gold coins in India bearing the portraits of kings (e.g., King Menander/Milinda).
- **Shaka (Scythians):** Nomadic tribes from Central Asia who displaced the Indo-Greeks. The most famous ruler was Rudradaman I.
- **Kushana (Kushan Empire):** Integrated Central Asia and North India. The greatest ruler, Kanishka, controlled the Silk Road and convened the 4th Buddhist Council.
- **Gupta (Gupta Empire):**
 - Referred to as the "Golden Age of India" due to immense advancements in art, architecture, science, mathematics (Aryabhata), and literature (Kalidasa).
 - Key rulers: Chandragupta I, Samudragupta, and Chandragupta II (Vikramaditya).
- **Huna (White Huns):** Central Asian nomadic invaders (led by Toramana and Mihirakula) whose relentless attacks significantly weakened and contributed to the fall of the Gupta Empire.

4. Delhi Sultanate (Turkic Rule) (GU KHA TU SALE)

The period of Islamic rule in India centered in Delhi, characterized by the succession of five distinct dynasties.

- **Ghulam (Slave Dynasty):**
 - **Q (Qutb-ud-din Aibak):** The founder of the Delhi Sultanate and initiator of the Qutb Minar.
 - **I (Iltutmish):** The real consolidator of the empire; introduced the silver tanka and copper jital.
 - **R (Razia Sultana):** The daughter of Iltutmish; historically significant as the first and only female Muslim ruler of Delhi.
 - **Ba (Ghiyas-ud-din Balban):** Known for his strict "Blood and Iron" policy to restore the prestige and power of the crown.
- **Khilji (Khalji Dynasty):** Founded by Jalal-ud-din. Its most prominent ruler, Alauddin Khalji, is known for his market control policies, standing army, and southern expeditions.
- **Tughlaq (Tughlaq Dynasty):** Known for ambitious but often flawed administrative experiments under Muhammad bin Tughlaq (like shifting the capital and introducing token currency), followed by welfare works under Firoz Shah Tughlaq.
- **Saiyed (Sayyid Dynasty):** A brief dynasty founded by Khizr Khan, who claimed descent from the Prophet Muhammad.
- **Lodi (Lodi Dynasty):** The final dynasty of the Sultanate (of Afghan origin). The last ruler, Ibrahim Lodi, was defeated by Babur in the First Battle of Panipat (1526).

5. Later Empires & Arrivals

- **Mongol:** Refers to the numerous invasions and raids by Mongol forces (from the times of Genghis Khan) that threatened the northwestern borders during the Delhi Sultanate.
- **Mughal (Mughal Empire):** Established by Babur. It unified most of the Indian subcontinent under centralized administration. Key "Great Mughals" include Akbar (administrative genius/religious tolerance), Shah Jahan (monumental architecture like the Taj Mahal), and Aurangzeb (maximum territorial expansion).
- **Iran (Iranians):** Refers primarily to the devastating invasion by Nader Shah in 1739, who sacked Delhi and looted the Peacock Throne and Koh-i-Noor diamond.
- **Afghan (Afghans):** Invasions led by Ahmad Shah Durrani (Abdali), culminating in the Third Battle of Panipat (1761), which dealt a severe blow to the Maratha Empire.
- **European:** The arrival of European trading companies (Portuguese, Dutch, British East India Company, French), leading to the eventual colonization of the subcontinent by the British.

6. Historical Markers

The **Allahabad Pillar** (also called Prayag Prashasti) is a major historical document. Here are the key details:

- **Maker:** Originally erected by the Mauryan Emperor **Ashoka**. The famous eulogy on it was commissioned by the Gupta Emperor **Samudragupta**.
- **Writer:** The text was composed by **Harisena**, Samudragupta's court poet and minister (Sandhivigrahika).
- **Mention of Pushyamitra:**
- **Earliest "India-Assam Link":** This inscription provides the **first historical evidence** linking ancient Assam to the Indian political map. It lists the region's kingdoms as tributary frontier states.
- **Bordering States Mentioned:**
It lists five frontier kingdoms (Pratyanta-nripati) that bordered the Gupta Empire:
 1. **Kamarupa** (Western Assam)
 2. **Davaka** (Central Assam/Nagaon region)
 3. **Samatata** (Southeast Bengal)
 4. **Nepala** (Nepal)
 5. **Kartripura** (Uttarakhand/Kumaon region)

Chapter 4: Assam Geography, Environment & Conservation

1. Physiographic Divisions

Assam is uniquely positioned geographically, acting as a gateway to the Northeast. It is primarily divided into three distinct physical regions:

- **The Brahmaputra Valley:**
 - **Features:** A narrow, elongated, and highly fertile alluvial plain spanning from Sadiya in the east to Dhubri in the west.
 - **Significance:** It is the most populous region, heavily agricultural, but highly susceptible to annual flooding.
- **The Barak Valley:**
 - **Features:** Located in the southern part of the state, formed by the Barak River. It encompasses the Cachar, Hailakandi, and Karimganj districts.
 - **Significance:** Characterized by its own distinct riverine ecosystem, wetlands (like Son Beel), and extensive tea gardens.
- **The Central Plateau and Hills (Karbi Anglong and North Cachar Hills):**
 - **Features:** Situated between the two valleys. Geologically, it is an extension of the Indian Peninsular Plateau (Meghalaya plateau).
 - **Significance:** Comprises rugged terrains, the Barail range, and dense tropical forests. It is home to the state's only hill station, Haflong.

2. River Systems (Tributary Mapping)

The Brahmaputra River Network:

- **NB (North Bank Tributaries):**
 - Siku/Jiari
 - Gal
 - Jiadhol
 - Subansiri (Note: Ranganadi and Dikrong are major sub-tributaries/adjacent basins joining the Subansiri network near the Brahmaputra)
 - Buroi
 - Borgang
 - Jia Bharali (Kameng)
 - Gabharu
 - Belsiri
 - Dhansiri (North)
 - Puthimari
 - Pagladiya
 - Manas (Note: Beki and Aie act as significant sub-tributaries)
 - Tipkai
 - Sankosh
 - Raidak (Gadadhar)
- **SB (South Bank Tributaries):**
 - Burhi Dihing
 - Disang
 - Dikhou
 - Jhanji
 - Bhogdoi
 - Dhansiri (South)
 - Kopili
 - Kulsi
 - Krishnai
 - Dudhnoi
 - Jinjiram

The Barak River Network:

North Bank Tributaries (East to West): Jiri, Chiri, Madhura, Jatinga, and Larang.

South Bank Tributaries (East to West): Sonai, Rukni, Ghagra, Katakhal, Dhaleshwari, and Longai.

3. Ecology & General Conservation

Assam is a vital ecological zone with multiple layers of protected areas.

- **BH (Biodiversity Hotspots):** Assam falls within two distinct global hotspots: the Eastern Himalayas and the Indo-Burma hotspot, making it a critical area for endemic species preservation.
- **WNHS (World Natural Heritage Sites):**
 - **Kaziranga National Park:** Recognized in 1985 for its unique floodplain ecosystem and highest density of Indian one-horned rhinoceroses.
 - **Manas Wildlife Sanctuary:** Recognized in 1985 for its spectacular scenery and diverse wildlife, including the Pygmy Hog and Golden Langur.
- **BR (Biosphere Reserves):**
 - **Manas Biosphere Reserve:** Spans the foothills of the Himalayas.
 - **Dibru-Saikhowa Biosphere Reserve:** A unique riverine island ecosystem in upper Assam.
- **NP (National Parks):** Assam currently has seven formally declared national parks:
 - Kaziranga NP (1974)
 - Manas NP (1990)
 - Nameri NP (1998)
 - Dibru-Saikhowa NP (1999)
 - Orang NP (1999)
 - Dehing Patkai NP (2021)
 - Raimona NP (2021)
 - Sikhna Jwhwlao NP (2025) (The newest addition, spanning Kokrajhar and Chirang districts to serve as a vital corridor for Golden Langurs)
- **WS (Wildlife Sanctuaries):**

Size Extremes:

 - **Marat Longri WS:** The biggest sanctuary in Assam.
 - **Garampani WS:** The oldest and smallest sanctuary in Assam.

Karbi Anglong & Golaghat Network:

- East Karbi Anglong WS
- North Karbi Anglong WS
- Nambor WS
- Nambor-Doigrung WS

Central & Northern Assam:

- Sonai-Rupai WS
- Behali WS
- Laokhowa WS
- Burhachapori WS
- Bornadi WS

Western & Southern Assam:

- Chakrashila WS
- Borail WS

Upper Assam & Specific Habitats:

- Hollongapar Gibbon WS
- Poba WS
- Pobitora WS
- Amchang WS
- Bherjan-Borajan-Padumoni WS
- **BS (Bird Sanctuaries): Pani Dihing (Sivasagar) and Bordoibam Beelmukh (Lakhimpur/Dhemaji).**
- **BEEL (Wetlands):**
 - Deepor Beel: Located near Guwahati, it is Assam's only recognized Ramsar Site.
 - Son Beel: The largest wetland in Assam, located in the Karimganj district.
 - Chandubi Beel: A natural lake formed during an earthquake in the Kamrup district.

4. Specialized Conservation Reserves

To protect mega-fauna, specific project-based reserves have been carved out across the state.

- **TR (Tiger Reserves):** Governed under 'Project Tiger' (launched in 1973). Assam has 4:
 1. Manas TR
 2. Nameri TR
 3. Kaziranga TR
 4. Orang TR
- **ER (Elephant Reserves):** Designated under 'Project Elephant' (launched in 1992) to protect habitats, migration corridors, and minimize human-elephant conflict. Assam has 5:
 1. Kaziranga-Karbi Anglong ER: The largest in the state (3,270 sq. km).
 2. Dhansiri-Lungding ER
 3. Chirang-Ripu ER
 4. Sonitpur ER
 5. Dihing Patkai ER

Chapter 5: Literary Sources of Assam's History

Ancient texts provide the foundational references for the region originally known as *Pragjyotisha* and later *Kamarupa*.

- **Vedic Literature (The Brahmanas):**
 - *Aitareya Brahmana*: Documents the eastward progress and expansion of early Aryan culture into the Kamarupa region.
 - *Satapatha Brahmana*: Notes the extension of Aryan culture up to the river Sadanira (identified as the Karatoya river), designating it as the permanent western boundary of ancient Assam.
 - *Gopatha Brahmana*: Narrates a popular mythological tradition regarding the origin of the name "Kamarupa," attributing it to the rebirth of Kamadeva (the god of love) after he was reduced to ashes by Lord Shiva's third eye.
- **The Great Epics:**
 - *Ramayana*: Records the foundation of the city of Pragjyotisha by Amurta Raja and locates the city of Pragjyotishpura on a gold-crested mountain known as Varunatalaya.
 - *Mahabharata*: Frequently mentions the city and country of Pragjyotisha. It prominently details King Bhagadatta, who joined the Kurukshetra war on the side of the Kauravas with an army consisting of Kiratas and Cinas.
- **Puranas & Tantric Texts:**
 - *The 7 Puranas*: Seven major Puranic texts (including the Vishnu and Markandeya Puranas) reference the region. They describe the inhabitants of the East, mention a Sun temple in Kamarupa, interchangeably use the names Pragjyotisha and Kamarupa, and depict the famous romance of Usha and Aniruddha.
 - *Kalika Purana*: Explains that Brahma made his first calculation of the stars here, translating "Pragjyotishpur" as the "City of Eastern Astrology." It defines Kamarupa's traditional boundaries as a triangle, bounded by the Karatoya river in the west and the Dikkaravasini in the east.
 - *Yogini Tantra*: Geographically and administratively divides the Kamarupa kingdom into four distinct sectors (*pithas*): Ratnapitha, Bhadrupitha, Saumarapitha, and Kamapitha.

Ancient Kamarupa (Pre-13th Century)

- **Mythological / Epic Period:**
 - **Danava Dynasty**: Founded by Mahiranga Danava, considered the earliest legendary ruler of the region.
 - **Bhauma-Naraka Dynasty**: Founded by Narakasura. His lineage includes Bhagadatta, the renowned warrior of the Mahabharata.

Chapter 6: Northeast India (The Seven Sisters)

This chapter provides a geographical and ecological profile of the contiguous northeastern states, excluding Assam (which is detailed in Chapters 4 & 5).

1. Arunachal Pradesh

- **Capital:** Itanagar
- **State Symbols:**
 - **Animal:** Mithun (*Bos frontalis*)
 - **Bird:** Great Hornbill (*Buceros bicornis*)
 - **Flower:** Foxtail Orchid (*Rhynchostylis retusa*)
- **Special Conserved Fauna:** Snow Leopard, Red Panda, Hoolock Gibbon.
- **Important National Parks:** Namdapha NP, Mouling NP.
- **Highest Peak:** Kangto Peak (7,090 m).
- **Major Hills:** Daffa Hills, Miri Hills, Abor Hills, and Mishmi Hills (part of the Eastern Himalayas).

2. Manipur

- **Capital:** Imphal
- **State Symbols:**
 - **Animal:** Sangai / Brow-antlered Deer (*Rucervus eldii eldii*)
 - **Bird:** Mrs. Hume's Pheasant / Nongin (*Symaticus humiae*)
 - **Flower:** Shirui Lily / Siroi Lily (*Lilium mackliniae*)
- **Special Conserved Fauna:** Sangai (endemic to the floating phumdis of Loktak Lake).
- **Important National Parks:** Keibul Lamjao NP (the world's only floating national park), Sirohi NP.
- **Highest Peak:** Mount Tempü / Mount Iso (2,994 m).
- **Major Hills:** Manipur Hills (part of the Purvanchal Range).

3. Meghalaya

- **Capital:** Shillong
- **State Symbols:**
 - **Animal:** Clouded Leopard (*Neofelis nebulosa*)
 - **Bird:** Hill Myna (*Gracula religiosa*)

- **Flower:** Lady's Slipper Orchid (*Paphiopedilum insigne*)
- **Special Conserved Fauna:** Clouded Leopard, Hoolock Gibbon.
- **Important National Parks:** Balpakram NP, Nokrek NP.
- **Highest Peak:** Shillong Peak (1,965 m).
- **Major Hills:** Garo, Khasi, and Jaintia Hills (comprising the Meghalaya Plateau).

4. Mizoram

- **Capital:** Aizawl
- **State Symbols:**
 - **Animal:** Himalayan Serow (*Capricornis thar*)
 - **Bird:** Mrs. Hume's Pheasant (*Symaticus humiae*)
 - **Flower:** Red Vanda (*Renanthera imschootiana*)
- **Special Conserved Fauna:** Serow, Asiatic Black Bear.
- **Important National Parks:** Murlen NP, Phawngpui NP.
- **Highest Peak:** Phawngpui / Blue Mountain (2,165 m).
- **Major Hills:** Mizo Hills (formerly Lushai Hills).

5. Nagaland

- **Capital:** Kohima
- **State Symbols:**
 - **Animal:** Mithun (*Bos frontalis*)
 - **Bird:** Blyth's Tragopan (*Tragopan blythii*)
 - **Flower:** Tree Rhododendron (*Rhododendron arboreum*)
- **Special Conserved Fauna:** Amur Falcon (during migration roosting), Blyth's Tragopan.
- **Important National Parks:** Ntangki NP.
- **Highest Peak:** Mount Saramati (3,841 m).
- **Major Hills:** Naga Hills, Patkai Bum (forming the border with Myanmar).

6. Tripura

- **Capital:** Agartala
- **State Symbols:**
 - **Animal:** Phayre's Leaf Monkey / Spectacled Langur (*Trachypitecus phayrei*)
 - **Bird:** Green Imperial Pigeon (*Ducula aenea*)
 - **Flower:** Nageshwar / Cobra Saffron (*Mesua ferrea*)
- **Special Conserved Fauna:** Phayre's Langur.
- **Important National Parks:** Clouded Leopard NP, Rajbari (Bison) NP.
- **Highest Peak:** Betlingchhip / Sibrai-khung (930 m).
- **Major Hills:** Jampui Hills, Atharamura Range.

Chapter 7: Prehistory (India & Northeast Focus)

1. Paleolithic Age (Old Stone Age)

Characterized by unpolished, rough stone tools. Divided into three phases based on tool typology and climatic shifts.

- **A. Lower Paleolithic (Early Stone Age):** Use of hand axes, cleavers, and choppers.
 - Bhimbetka (Madhya Pradesh)
 - Hunsgi (Karnataka)
 - Attirampakkam (Tamil Nadu)
 - Belan Valley (Uttar Pradesh)
 - Didwana (Rajasthan)
 - **Bori (Pune District, Maharashtra)**
- **B. Middle Paleolithic (Middle Stone Age):** Use of flake tools like scrapers, borers, and points.
 - Nevasa (Maharashtra)
 - Luni Valley (Rajasthan)
 - **Narmada Valley (Madhya Pradesh)**
 - Bhimbetka (Madhya Pradesh)
 - **Daphabum (Lohit Valley, Arunachal Pradesh) - Key Northeast Site**
- **C. Upper Paleolithic (Late Stone Age):** Use of blade-based tools; emergence of Homo sapiens.
 - **Kurnool Caves (Andhra Pradesh)**
 - Patne (Maharashtra)
 - Renigunta (Andhra Pradesh)
 - **Rongram Valley (Garo Hills, Meghalaya) - Key Northeast Site**
 - **Khangkhui Caves (Ukhrul, Manipur) - Key Northeast Site**

2. Mesolithic Age (Transitional Stone Age)

Characterized by the domestication of animals, warmer climates, and the use of tiny, specialized stone tools called microliths.

- **Bagor (Rajasthan)**
- Adamgarh (Madhya Pradesh)
- Langhnaj (Gujarat)
- Sarai Nahar Rai (Uttar Pradesh)
- Mahadaha (Uttar Pradesh)

3. Neolithic Age (New Stone Age)

Marked by the advent of agriculture, settled communities, polished stone tools, and the invention of pottery.

- **Burzahom (Jammu & Kashmir)**
- Chirand (Bihar)
- Piklihal (Karnataka)
- **Daojali Hading (Dima Hasao, Assam): Discovered highly polished stone tools and cord-marked pottery.**
- **Sarutaru (Kamrup, Assam): Discovered shouldered celts and round-buttled axes.**
- **Selbaqiri (Garo Hills, Meghalaya): Significant Neolithic stone tool workshops.**
- **Notable Artifact Discovery: A unique six-grooved stone hammer was discovered at Biswanath (Assam).**